

6.5 A Little Technical Digression

We now present a few Q&As about some of the technologies mentioned above.

The Symbian OS

Symbian OS is an operating system designed specifically for mobile devices. It is being developed by Symbian Ltd, a software licensing company that supplies the operating system for many data-enabled mobile phones.

How does Symbian OS work?

As an operating system software, Symbian OS provides the underlying routines and services for application software. For example, an email software that interacts with a user through a mobile phone screen and downloads email messages to the phone's inbox over a mobile network or WiFi access, is using the communication protocols and file management routines provided by the Symbian OS.

Symbian OS technology has been designed with these key points in mind:

- To provide power, memory and input & output resource management specifically required in mobile devices
- To deliver an open platform that complies with global telecommunications and Internet standards
- To provide tools for developing mobile software for business, media and other applications
- To ensure the wide availability of applications and accessories for different user requirements
- To facilitate wireless connectivity for a variety of networks

About Symbian OS

Nokia has made Symbian OS its strategic choice for smartphone operating systems. The Nokia Series 60 Platform, currently the most widely used software platform in the smartphone market worldwide, runs on Symbian OS—as does the advanced Nokia Series 80 Communicator devices. The Symbian OS-based Nokia Series 90 platform delivers touch screen technology and an advanced software development environment for media-rich applications.